an Army HQ reserve. By harvesting one or two Divisions from dormant sectors, a Strike Corps could be recreated and allotted to the LTC (W), should the need arise. A similar arrangement could be worked out for critical and high-value air assets, such as the AWACS or mid-air refuellers. The workhorses though, the front-line squadrons had to be integral to the Theatre, the very *raison d'être* for the term 'Integrated Theatre Command'. The recommendations of the war game, including integrated verticals with cross-staffing of appointments, did not find favour with the Air Force, which insisted on a service-specific model. Similarly, placing the Theatre air space under the Theatre Commander was also not agreed to by the Air Force.[19] Nevertheless, these recommendations were forwarded to the CDS and once again tabled in the DMA in the presence of all Service Chiefs and Principal Staff Officers (PSO). Once again, the Air Force was not in favour of apportioning resources, arguing that dispersing resources thinly over the respective Theatres would considerably diminish its operational philosophy of using their assets in interchangeable strategic and tactical roles, through centralized planning at the Air HQ level and decentralized execution by the concerned Air Bases. This seemed to suggest that all intermediate links were redundant, which then begged the question: Why the requirement of an AOC-in-C?

Regardless, we were making some progress and the CDS had drawn up a road map, which entailed formalizing of structures and the organogram by the end of 2021, obtaining 'in-principle' of the CCS for the proposed ITC by April 2022, test-bedding the same, making mid-course corrections and then getting final approval by end-2022. Unfortunately, due to the tragic crash of 8 December 2021, there was no further progress on this 'Front' and it is now for the current CDS to take Theaterization forward.

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